Investigating historical municipal citations is a high-value strategy because the **handwriting on summons or permit applications** could provide a baseline for forensic comparison against the Zodiac's known letters. For a property manager like **Thomas Riese**, municipal compliance records are the most likely source of his handwritten signatures and notes.

1. Nuisance Abatement & Littering Citations
In the 1960s, the **San Francisco Department of Public Health (SFDPH)** and **Public Works** were responsible for enforcing "Anti-Blight" ordinances.

- **Target Records:** Look for **Health Code Article 6 (Garbage and Refuse)** or **Article 12 (General Sanitation)** violations. Citations for "illegal dumping" or "refuse accumulation" at Riese-managed properties would be issued to the property manager of record.
- **Handwriting Source:** If Riese contested a citation, his handwritten **Notice of Appeal** or correspondence with the **Board of Permit Appeals** would be part of the official case file.
- **Where to find:** SFDPH records from 1865–1951 are archived, but for the 1960s, you must submit a **Public Records Request** to the SFDPH Records Management Office.

2. Building Permits & Job Cards
As a real estate professional, Riese likely filed numerous **Building Permit Applications** for maintenance and renovations in the Richmond District.

- **The "Job Card":** These cards (available from 1933 onward) often contain the handwritten notes of the applicant or the contractor.
- **Handwriting Source:** The Department of Building Inspection (DBI) holds **Permit Applications** where the "Owner's Agent" (Tom Riese) would have to sign and potentially fill out project descriptions by hand.
- **Where to find:** You can search by address using the DBI Permit Tracking System. For copies of original handwritten documents prior to 1990, you must visit **City Hall, Room 190**

3. Small Manuscripts & Personal Papers
The **San Francisco History Center** at the SF Public Library maintains a **Small Manuscript Collection**.

- **Business Correspondence:** This collection includes receipts, tax bills, and leases. If the Riese "syndicate" donated or had their business papers seized/archived, this is where handwritten leases or tenant agreements would be stored.
- **Where to find:** Consult the Small Manuscripts Guide (PDF) or speak with a reference librarian at the **6th Floor History Center**

Record Type	Likely Handwriting Content	Primary Archive
Blight Citations	Notice of Appeal, signature.	SFDPH Records
Building Permits	Application forms, Job Cards.	DBI Records Management
Recorded Deeds	Grantor signatures (Pre-1990).	Assessor-Recorder (City Hall 190)
Tenant Leases	Management notes, signatures.	SFPL History Center